

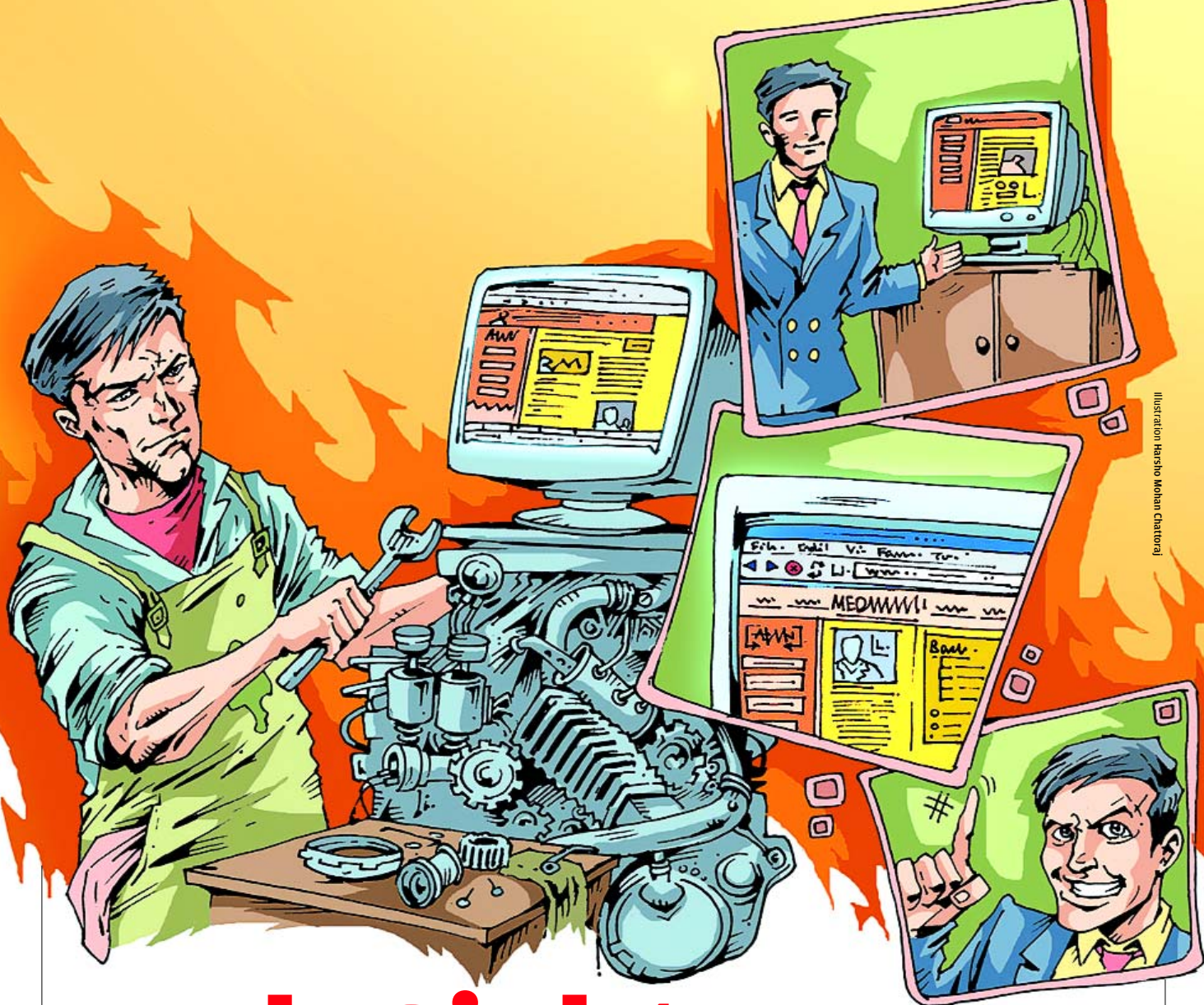


Illustration Harsho Mohan Chaturaj

Web Sights

It's not enough to just make a professional Web site... you need to get search engines to notice it

Robert Sovereign-Smith

At last estimate, there were over 40 million (that's four crore) registered domains. You need to keep in mind that this is just the number of TLDs (Top Level Domains) that have been registered, not the number of Web pages there are on the Internet. A simple experiment: search Google for the word "the", and you get over 6 billion results—and none from the "Deep Web," or what search engines don't scour.

These numbers can make you feel really, really small. And you thought of setting up a Web site, for personal or professional reasons, hoping to find some

business online, or just to let the world know you exist! So what's so special about you and your site? For one, you're armed with a copy of *Digit*!

As a follow up to the article in *Digit*'s November 2004 issue, titled "www.mybusiness.com", on page 84—which dealt with how to buy a domain, set the DNS forwarding and cloaking options to make your site look professionally hosted—this article will focus more on how you can create a professional Web site, and then get search engines to sit up and take notice.

The Bundled Builder

Not everyone can afford Web site-building software such as Macromedia Dreamweaver, but a

lot of people have Microsoft Office. The beauty of MS Office is that it comes with Microsoft Frontpage—an easy-to-use Web site builder.

If you have Microsoft Office installed, you will find Frontpage by going to **Start > Programs > Microsoft Frontpage**. If you don't have Microsoft Office installed, you can purchase it from <http://www.microsoft.com/india/office/default.aspx>.

When Frontpage is installed, it will create a folder called "My Webs" in your "My Documents" folder, where all Web sites you create will be stored. Go to **File > New > Page or Web...**, and you will see a panel on the right that asks you what you want to build. Click on "Web Site Templates..."